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Brief for a research director: post quantum command and update channels for drones and robots

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Question. Will standardised post quantum algorithms fit and run on the flight controllers and radio links that drones and robots use, and which devices must be replaced rather than updated?

What the evidence shows now.

- Real flight stack builds (10, host measured) leave little flash: 6.0 to 45.9 kB free on default PX4 builds. With measured memory the estimated median share of a fleet needing new hardware rises from 0.201 to 0.300.
- A hybrid session keeps command availability on a telemetry radio at 0.991; signing every command lowers it to 0.794 (estimated).
- The session and update design was checked formally: 39 of 57 queries proved, design flaws F1 to F3 found and fixed (modelled).
- The cycle model is accurate within one code base (1.0 percent) but not across schemes (9.8 percent); nothing is yet measured on a microcontroller.

What is proposed. 12 months, part time: one afternoon on two borrowed boards scored against 36 registered predictions, a software in the loop rerun with the replay rule enforced, a borrowed radio pair, a run time memory profile, and a design note with dataset release. Readiness of the command channel: TRL 2 now, TRL 4 planned at the end (lab only; scale in the full proposal).

Fit. Deliverables map to sections 6.1.1, 6.1.2, 6.1.3, 6.1.4, 6.1.5, 6.1.6 of the UAE National Encryption Policy (quoted terms and page in the full proposal, section 7) and to public facts TII-02, TII-03, EDGE-02, TII-04, TII-05, EDGE-04, TII-06, EDGE-05, ADEO-03, ADEO-04, EDGE-01, EDGE-03, TII-07, ADEO-02, TII-08 in `docs/CONTEXT_ENTITIES.md`. The project does not fulfil any entity’s duty and implies no endorsement.

The ask. Supervision; a few hours of lab access to two development boards, a multimeter and a telemetry radio pair; one representative flight controller profile. Purchases: 0.